

2026

**AKRON
MARATHON**
RACE SERIES

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EVENT GUIDE



KIDS FUN RUN SCHEDULE Friday, September 25, 2026

5:00 p.m. – Registration & Bib Pickup Opens /
Announcements Begin

5:45 p.m. – Opening Ceremony Starts

6:00 p.m. – Race Starts

7:30 p.m. – Event Ends

8:00 p.m. – Children's Museum Closes

LOCATIONS

Race Start:
Akron Children's Hospital
214 W. Bowery Street, Akron, OH 44308

Race Finish
Lock 3
200 S. Main Street, Akron, OH 44308



TAKE A LOOK INSIDE

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Directions

From the north via Turnpike I-80 East/Rt. 8 South to the Summit County Parking Deck:

- Follow Rt. 8 South to Perkins St. exit. Turn right on Perkins St. Turn left on High St. Deck will be on the right.

From the north via I-77 & west via I-76 (they run concurrently briefly) to the State Street Deck:

- I-77/I-76 (they run concurrently). Take the exit for Main/Downtown/Univ of Akron. Stay to the left after you exit and make a left turn at the first light onto Main St. Main St. becomes Broadway. Turn left on State St. Deck will be on the right.

From the south via I-77 to the Summit County Parking Deck:

- Take I-77 and continue on Route 8 north. Exit at Perkins St. Turn left onto Perkins St. Turn left on High St. Deck will be on the right.

From the east Via I-76 to the State Street Parking Deck:

- I-76/I-77 (they run concurrently) Exit at Main/Broadway/Downtown. Continue onto Broadway. Turn left on State St. Deck will be on the right.

Parking

Parking for the Kids Fun Run will be at the Summit County Deck (200 S. High St.) and at the State Street Deck/O'Neils Parking Garage (51 W. State St.).

- Walking directions from the State Street Parking Deck: Walk west on State St. and turn left onto Bowery St. to get to the registration tent located in front of Akron Children's Hospital.
- Walking directions from the Summit County Deck: Walk south on High St. then turn right on State St. and left on Bowery St. to get to the registration tent located in front of Akron Children's Hospital.



Bib Pickup

Each child will receive a race bib with a number assigned to it. If you are pre-registered, you will pick up your child's bib at the Registration Tent in front of Akron Children's Hospital near the corner of Exchange St. and Bowery St. Please enter the tent following the alphabetical signage, by last name. If you did not pre-register, find the on-site registration table at the far left side of the tent. After the bib is picked up, all parents should confirm the emergency contact information on the back of the bib. This bib will also have a tear off tag for the adult accompanying the child to keep, that has the same bib number as the child. In the case of an adult and child getting separated, upon being reunited, the adult will be asked to show the tag to confirm it matches the number on the child's bib.



Giveaway

At Bib Pickup, all children will receive a free headband!



DJ Lily Jade

Get pumped up at the start line with tunes from DJ Lily Jade!

Mascots from the community will energize the start line experience!



Medical

Medical will be available next to the Registration Tent.

Restrooms

Restrooms will be available on Bowery St. near the start line corrals and inside the Finisher Festival.

Start Line

Participants will line up based on their age. Look for the age group signs along the starting corral. Families with multiple children that prefer to run together will start in the wave corresponding to the youngest participant's age.

Be in your corral by 5:45 pm for the start of the race at 6:00 pm. Starting the race in age groups creates a smoother start for all participating.

All walkers and families with strollers should start in the purple wave. Each wave will be walked up to the start line & have their own separate start. The waves will be as follows:

Wave 1 (Blue)
Includes children ages 9-12

Wave 2 (Yellow)
Includes children ages 7-8

Wave 3 (Green)
Includes children ages 5-6

Wave 4 (Purple)
Includes children ages 4 and under

Course Information

The Mandel Family Kids Fun Run course is run on paved asphalt and concrete streets. See the course map on page 7.

Course Limit

The Kids Fun Run course will be open until 6:45 p.m., or until the final child crosses the finish line.

First Aid

First aid will be provided by Akron Children's at the start line, the finish line medical tent on S. Main St, and at the finisher festival by the info booth.

Lost & Found

All items left at the event will be taken to the Information Booth located in Lock 3 at the Finisher Festival then returned to the Marathon office. Two weeks after the event, unclaimed items will be donated to a local charity. The Akron Marathon is not responsible for lost items.

Info Booths

For your convenience, Information Booths can be found inside the registration tent at the start line & inside Lock 3 at the Finisher Festival.

Prohibited on the Race Course

For the safety of our participants, the Akron Marathon does not permit pets, skateboards, bicycles, roller blades, or any other types of vehicles (other than official race vehicles) on the course. Please do not bring or carry any of these items with you. The Akron Marathon reserves the right to remove anyone from the course who has any of the above items or does not act in a safe manner. All participants accept the rules of the race and abide by the decision of any race officials concerning the participant's ability to safely complete the race.



Finish Line

The finish line for The Mandel Family Kids Fun Run will be on S. Main St. in front of Lock 3 (200 S. Main St.). Once across the finish line, participants will receive a commemorative medal, apple, water, chocolate milk, and goodie bag. Participants will then exit the finish line chute and reunite with family at the Finisher Festival located in Lock 3.

Lost Child Protocol

If you get separated from your child, please approach a uniformed race official or Akron police officer and provide the name and bib number of your child. You will be asked to report to the finish line information booth until we can reunite you with your child. Your child's race bib number must match the adult's corresponding tag number.



Family Reunion

Kids running without their parents should reunite with them outside of the runner chute located on S. Main St. For the safety of all participants, the runner chute is for exiting participants only, waiting parents must remain outside of it.

Safety

Upon arriving at the Kids Fun Run please determine a meet-up plan with your child in case you get separated. Each child will receive a race bib for the race. There is a removable tag with the bib number for the adult to keep. If you become separated from the child, you will be asked to show this tag when reunited with the child. If your child is under the age of 5, a parent/guardian must participate in the event!



Festival Vendors & Activities

Inside the Finisher Festival, you can visit the following vendors:

- Acme Fresh Market
- Akron Public Schools
- Akron-Summit County Public Library
- Camp Quality
- Embracing Futures & Downtown Akron Kiwanis
- KidStrong
- Open Arms Adoptions
- Patricia Ann Cargill Charities
- PNC Bank
- Scouts - Canal District
- Summit County Children's Services
- Summit Soil & Water Conservation District

Enjoy the tunes from DJ Bobby on the festival stage.

PNC Bank - Mobile Learning Adventure

Visit the Mobile Learning Adventure, a guided interactive experience with fun and educational activities.



Race Photos

FinisherPix will be the official race photographer. To view your child's photos, you will look the child up by their race bib number. Photos can be viewed at AkronMarathon.org the week following the race. You will receive an email notifying you when the pictures are ready to be viewed.

Akron Children's Museum

Visit the Akron Children's Museum, which will be FREE to all Kids Fun Run participants by showing your race bib! The Akron Children's Museum will offer special hours Friday from 6:00 to 8:00 p.m. Access the museum by entering the commons entrance within Lock 3 and following the signs.





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Mandel Family



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Event Partners

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PNC Bank
Rubber City Reuse
Scouts - Canal District
Summa Health
Summit County Children's Services
Summit Soil & Water Conservation District
The University of Akron